

I have never met a more generous, a larger-hearted set than "Wall Street millionaires." Even the worst of them have the redeeming virtues of generosity and charity. They practise these virtues, too, on a scale the public can not imagine.

On the other hand, there are a few black sheep in the "Wall Street millionaire" fold. The most rapid-fire swearer and blasphemer I have ever encountered is one of our very prominent traction magnates. And his vocabulary betrays him as being what he really is. Then others admittedly could not write Greek poetry nor rival Caesar or Cicero as Latin writers.

But that is their misfortune rather than their fault. Quite a few of them do their best to make up for what they missed. They try hard to develop a taste for and an appreciation of art and music. They spend lavishly in encouraging and cultivating the refinements of life. They may know more about Reading than about Rembrandts, but when they get away from the one they do often try to become acquainted with the other.

The trouble is that the crazy exploits of the few besmirch the reputation of the many. . . . when a Wall Street plutocrat runs amuck it makes a spicy front-page story.

Then there is another and more numerous class of "Wall Street millionaires." Men of the Morgan, Speyer, Seligman, Kahn, Barton Hepburn calibre need no apologist on the score of culture. Not a few of the finest intellects in the country find their sphere of activity in "Wall Street."

Mixing the good with the bad, the resulting composite "Wall Street millionaire" is not such a worthless, disreputable, dishonest character as is too often misrepresented.